[1] When computers first started to be used on a wide scale, some people predicted that we would spend so long staring at computer screens that we would end up forgetting how to talk to one another. But in fact, the rapid expansion of electronic communication in the 21st century has had the opposite effect. Rather than retreating into themselves, people are using new technology, in particular email and text massaging, to find more and more ways to expand their network of friends.

[2] Jane Adams, 23, sends so many messages to her friends. She's known as the Text Queen. 'My friends and I take our phones out with us and send messages to other friends saying "**we**'re in this club and it's really good. Come and meet us", she said. It means we don't have to spend ages planning an evening out. You can just send the same message to everyone.

[3] Text messaging and email also help Jane keep in touch with old schoolmates she would probably have lost contact with otherwise. She finds that it's easier to send a message saying "Hi! thinking of you", rather than having to write a long letter.

[4] It seems these forms of communication have filled a gap, offering something that face-to-face conversation does not. Professor Pam Briggs, a psychologist at the University of Northumbria, believes they have become popular because they people an opportunity to present themselves in the way that they want to. 'People seem to really enjoy sending text messages and emails, she says. 'They can take their time planning their message. They prefer it to speaking on the phone to each other- maybe also because this way they can choose when they want to respond to someone.'

[5] The fact that text messages are so quick and easy is a big part of the attraction. Many people also find text messaging more informal than making a phone call or writing a letter, and therefore simpler to use. Ann Rose, who teaches at a London school, uses email and text messaging to keep in touch with students. 'I have always given my number out to students and told them to call me if **they** have any problems. But no one ever did. Now, they often email or text me with questions about their work. They don't find it difficult to keep in touch that way, whereas they might feet that a phone call is more of an interruption, 'she said.

[6] So is all good, Ann has identified one negative result of text messaging. 'The popularity of **this way of writing** among my students,' she says 'can cause a few difficulties as they have started using abbreviations such as 'ruok' for 'are you okay? And 'thx' for thanks"

I. COMPREHENSION (15 points)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT

A. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS IN YOUR AWN WORDS: (4 pts)

1. What effect has been caused by the expansion of electronic communication?

……..

2. Why is Jane Adams called the "Text Queen"?

……..

3. In what ways are text messaging and e-mailing different from face-to-face conversation according to Pr Briggs?

a. ……

b. ……

B. ARE THESE SENTENCES TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY: (3 pts)

1. Jane Adams and her friends find that text messaging saves time in organizing meetings.

……..

2. Jane keeps in contact with her old school friends thanks to email and text messaging.

……..

3. Ann Rose used to receive phone calls from her students.

……..

C. COMPLETE THESE SENTENCES FROM THE TEXT (3 pts)

1. Some people thought that the expansion of the use of computers would stop them from ……

……..

2. To ask questions about their work, Ann Rose's students. ……

……..

3. According to Ann Rose, the negative effect of text messaging on students' writing is ……..

……..

D. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS OR EXPRESSIONS THAT MEAN THE SAME AS: (2 pts)

1. to increase (Paragraph 1): ……..……

2. a chance (Paragraph 4): ……

E. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? 3 pts

1. We: ……

2. They: ……

3. This way of writing: ……..

A. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE APPROPRIATE WORDS FROM THE LIST: (1,5 pt)

who – whom - whose - which - where - when

Adil Imam, ……..…… sense of humor is appreciated by many people, is an Egyptian actor ……..…… has played funny roles in many plays and movies. He often acts out simple situations ……..…… can make you laugh for hours.

B. REWRITE THE SENTENCES BEGINNING WITH THE WORDS GIVEN: (3 pts)

1. Swimming and fishing aren't allowed in this lake.

People …….

2. "Please stop arguing and listen to me, "Mrs. Williams said.

Mrs. Williams told the two students …….

3. I can't see my friends while chatting because I don't have a webcam.

If only ……

C. PUT THE VERBS BETWEEN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE: (1,5 pts)

The Simons (to live) ……..……in Marrakesh for ten years when I first (to meet) …… them in 1988. By the end of 2028, they (to be) ……..…… in Morocco for thirty years.

D. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE PHRASAL VERB: (3 pts)

1. I'm ……..……our trip to France. We're leaving next month.

a. bringing about b. coping with c. looking forward to

2. Bill proposed to marry Sue but she ……his proposal.

a. broke down b. turned down c. calmed down

3. That little boy always ..... excuses for being late.

a. makes up b. takes up c. looks up

E. FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE APPROPRIATE WORDS FROM THE LIST: (3 pts)

disagreement - exclude - pace - empower - status - development

The best way to …… women and improve their ..…… is to educate them. It's also useful to help them become financially independent. Thus, they can participate in the ……..…… of their society.

F. JOIN THE PAIRS OF SENTENCES WITH THE LINKING WORDS GIVEN.

1. Many people still use plastic bags. They are dangerous for the environment.(although)

…….

2. Some skilled workers emigrate. They aren't satisfied with low salaries in their home countries. (therefore)

……..

3. We rarely play music at night. We don't want to disturb our neighbors. (so as not)

…….

WRITING (10 POINTS)

The editor of your school magazine is organizing a competition on the importance of education in people's lives. Write a short article about your experience as a student and the benefits you get from school in general. (Approximately 250 words)

Here are some suggestions to help you:

- Your favorite school subjects . the skills learn
- Your school life experience (class. schoolmates, teachers, relationships, projects, extra-curricular activities, etc.) - Your future projects (carry on your studies or look a job)
- The effects of school or education on your own and your family's life.

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Baccalaureate English National Exam Arts July 2008 · Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

A. Answer these questions in your own words. (4 pts)

1. It has had the opposite effect of what some people predicted: instead of becoming isolated, people use email and text messaging to expand their network of friends.
2. Because she sends so many messages to her friends.
3. a. They give people an opportunity to present themselves in the way they want.
   b. People can take their time planning their message and choose when to respond.

B. Are these sentences true or false? Justify. (3 pts)

1. **True.** "It means we don't have to spend ages planning an evening out." (paragraph 2)
2. **True.** "Text messaging and email also help Jane keep in touch with old schoolmates." (paragraph 3)
3. **False.** "I have always given my number out to students… But no one ever did." (paragraph 5)

C. Complete these sentences from the text. (3 pts)

1. …talking to one another (forgetting how to talk to one another).
2. …email or text her.
3. …that they have started using abbreviations such as "ruok" and "thx".

D. Find in the text words or expressions that mean the same as: (2 pts)

1. expand
2. opportunity

E. What do the underlined words in the text refer to? (3 pts)

1. Jane Adams and her friends
2. People who send text messages and emails
3. Text messaging (using abbreviations)

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

A. Fill in the gaps with the appropriate words from the list. (1.5 pts) whose · who · which

B. Rewrite the sentences beginning with the words given. (3 pts)

1. People **aren't allowed to swim or fish in this lake**.
2. Mrs. Williams told the two students **to stop arguing and listen to her**.
3. If only **I had a webcam, I could see my friends while chatting**.

C. Put the verbs between brackets in the correct tense. (1.5 pts) had been living (or had lived) · met · will have been

D. Fill in each gap with an appropriate phrasal verb. (3 pts)

1. c. looking forward to
2. b. turned down
3. a. makes up

E. Fill in the gaps with the appropriate words from the list. (3 pts) empower · status · development

F. Join the pairs of sentences with the linking words given. (3 pts)

1. **Although they are dangerous for the environment, many people still use plastic bags.**
2. **Some skilled workers aren't satisfied with low salaries in their home countries; therefore, they emigrate.**
3. **We rarely play music at night so as not to disturb our neighbors.**

III. WRITING (10 POINTS)

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Model answer: What School Has Given Me School is much more than a building where we learn lessons: it shapes our character and our future. I would like to share my experience as a student and the benefits I get from education. My favorite subjects are English and science. In English I learn to communicate with people from other countries, and in science I learn to think logically and solve problems. School also teaches me teamwork, because we prepare projects and take part in clubs together. My teachers and my classmates have become a second family, and they support me when I am under pressure. In the future, I would like to carry on my studies at university and become an engineer. Education will give me the skills to find a good job and to help my family, who have always sacrificed for my studies. To sum up, education changes the life of the student and the life of his or her family. That is why every young person should value school.